FREMONT UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
Emergency Communications System
Radio Usage Protocol

General Procedure

The Fremont Unified School District employs a radio system for its emergency communications. The system is also designed to be used for the District's daily non-emergency 2-way radio communications. In order to ensure proper use of the system, radio users should be familiar with the following procedures:

- Use correct speech technique.
- Ensure that your radio is on the proper channel BEFORE transmitting.
- Initiate radio contact by identifying yourself and your intended recipient.
- Clearly state your intention and the information you wish to convey.
- Standard procedure words may take the place of entire sentences (see examples).
    - Roger = "I have received your last transmission"
    - Out = "Ending transmission, no reply is necessary."
- End each transmission by saying "Over" or "Out."
- Certain channels are received by many other radio users. Consider your audience carefully before transmitting.
- Title 18 of the United States Code, Section 1464, prohibits the utterance of any obscene, indecent or profane language by means of radio communication.
- Remember that these are public airwaves and the general public has the ability to listen in. Keep your transmissions brief and adhere to business-related communications.

Speech Technique

To ensure that other radio users are able to understand and clearly receive your transmission, all radio users should follow these basic techniques when speaking:

- Radio users should position the radio's microphone as close to the mouth as possible.
- Speak clearly and use short sentences divided into sensible phrases (don't pause after every word).
- Maintain a natural speech rhythm.
- When pausing, release the talk button to allow other radio users to respond.
- Speak at a normal volume. Shouting will cause distortion.

Transmitting a Message

Before transmitting your message, ensure that your radio is on the correct channel PRIOR to transmitting. Certain channels are received by many users district-wide. Ensuring your radio is on the proper channel will minimize interruptions to other radio users. Refer to the radio channel cards that were given to you at the time the radio was issued.

Following the two steps below will ensure that all other radio users who hear the message know the channel is being used appropriately and to the radio traffic can be ignored.

- Identify the intended target recipient of your message.
- Identify yourself first by stating your site number or call sign.

Example:
Broadcast - *"Kennedy High School, Kennedy High School, this is Maintenance Base. Come in, over."*
Reply - *"Maintenance Base, this is Kennedy High School, go ahead."*

Corrections

When a radio user makes an error while transmitting a message and you need to provide corrected information, say the word "Correction" followed with the correct information.

On occasion, you might make a broadcast on an incorrect channel. Proper radio procedure is to cancel the broadcast on the incorrect channel by saying the phrase "Cancel previous transmission" or "Disregard previous broadcast". This is especially important if a broadcast on the Emergency Channel is made so that all other radio users know there is not an actual emergency.

Rules for Spelling

Use the following International Phonetic Alphabet to spell words or acronyms that may not transmit clearly:

A — Alpha	B — Bravo	C — Charlie	D — Delta	E — Echo
F — Foxtrot	G — Golf	H — Hotel	I — India	J — Juliet
K — Kilo	L — Lima	M — Mike	N — November	O — Oscar
P — Papa	Q — Quebec	R — Romeo	S — Sierra	T — Tango
U — Uniform	V — Victor	W — Whiskey	X — Xray	Y — Yankee
Z — Zulu				

Radio 10-Codes

"10-codes" are used to abbreviate common words and phrases to save time and communicate efficiently. The following 10-codes are used by emergency responders.

10-1	Receiving Poor
10-2	Receiving OK
10-4	OK
10-5	Relay to:
10-7	Out of Service at:
10-8	In Service
10-9	Repeat
10-10	Out of Service at Home
10-12	Visitor/Officer present
10-13	Weather/Road Conditions
10-15	Have prisoner in custody
10-16	Pickup:
10-18	Equipment check
10-19 A	Arrived/Returned to Pound
10-19 B	Arrived/Returned to Corp Yard
10-19 C	Arrived/Returned to Headquarters
10-19 D	Arrived/Returned to Airport
10-20	Location
10-21	Phone Office or Landline
10-22	Cancel
10-23	Standby
10-24	Check file/permit/record
10-25	Do you have contact with:

10-27	Check license info
10-28	Registration
10-29	Check for wants and warrants
10-30	Resume normal radio traffic
10-32	Drowning
10-33	Alarm Sounding
10-34	Open Door
10-35	Open Window
10-39	Message delivered
10-40	Is ___ available for phone call?
10-45	Ambulance needed
10-49	Proceed to:
10-50	Obtain a report
10-52	Resuscitator
10-53	Man down
10-54	Possible dead body
10-56	Suicide
10-57	Firearm discharged
10-58	Garbage complaint
10-60	Check Parking Meter
10-62	Meet the citizen
10-65	Missing person
10-66	Suspicious person

Common Standard Procedure Words

Here is a list of standard procedure words and their meanings that are widely used in radio transmissions.

Acknowledge	Confirm that you have received my message and will comply.
Affirmative	Yes/Correct
Negative	No/Incorrect
Break-Break-Break	All radio users on the channel will immediately cease transmission. (Emergency only)
Correct	You are correct
Correction	The correct version is…
Disregard this transmission-Out	This transmission is an error. Disregard it.
Over	I have finished my turn. Please respond.
Out	I have finished my communication.
Roger	I have received your last transmission satisfactorily.
Roger so far?	Have you received this part of my transmission ok?
Say again	Repeat all of your last transmission.
Say again all	Repeat the portion of the message indicated.
Say again after	Repeat the portion of the message indicated.
I say again	I am repeating my transmission.
Wilco	I have received and understood your message and will comply.

Acknowledgement of Messages

You may request an acknowledgement of the message to ensure that someone at a site has received it. This is useful if you want to make sure your message has been received, but the message recipient may not be able to provide a complete response at that moment. Request a message acknowledgement by finishing your message with the words "(Site, call sign, or user name: Acknowledge".

Example:

Broadcast - "Hirsch ES, Hirsch ES, this is the DO. Initiate lock down procedure immediately, acknowledge."
Reply - "District Office, this is Hirsch ES. Message acknowledged, wilco."

Break-in Procedure

At times when radio traffic is high, you may need to interrupt a communication that is currently happening between two other radio users due to a more important message you need to transmit. You may break into the transmissions by saying the phrase "Flash", "Immediate", or "Priority" followed by your message. When the preceding phrases are spoken 3 times it means for all other users to cease transmissions immediately and to wait for the radio user that is breaking the transmission to pass their message. The radio user that is breaking will end the radio break-in by ending the transmission with the phrase "Out".

If there is activity on a channel that is being used inappropriately, the district or the dispatcher may ask the channel to be cleared of transmissions by saying the phrase "Clear channel XX". When you hear a request for a channel to be cleared, make sure your radio is on the proper channel for your communication and proceed with your transmission.